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KJV Life in the Spirit Study Bible

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Author's Preface

The vision, call and urgency from God for this study Bible came to me while serving as a missionary in Brazil. I realized how much Christian workers needed a Bible that would give them direction in their thinking and preaching. Thus, ten years ago I began writing the notes and articles for this work. Later, when I came back to the United States for a short period of time, I discovered a similar desire among both pastors and lay people for a study Bible with notes that have a Pentecostal emphasis.

During the past number of years I have written with an increasing assurance that the Holy Spirit is not confined to the pages of Scripture, but that he wants to act today as he did in Bible times. The Spirit has come to remain personally with God's people, and his abiding presence is to be manifested in righteousness and power (Mat 6:33; Rom 14:17; 1 Cor 2:4; 4:20; Heb 1:8). In and through the church, God's Spirit desires to work in the same manner as he did in the earthly ministry of Jesus and continued to do in the apostolic church of the first century.

This study Bible is called the *KJV Life in the Spirit Study Bible*. It has been so named because it is founded on three fundamental convictions:

(1) The original revelation of Christ and the apostles as recorded in the Bible is fully inspired by the Holy Spirit; along with the OT, it is God's inerrant and infallible truth and the ultimate authority for the church of Christ today. All believers throughout history are dependent on the words and teachings of Biblical revelation for determining God's standard of truth and practice. In other words, we must view the NT message, standards and experience as God's preeminent pattern for the church, valid for all times.

(2) It is the task of every generation of believers not only to accept the NT as God's inspired Word, but also to sincerely seek to reproduce in their personal lives and congregations the same faith, devotion and power demonstrated in and through the faithful members of the early church. I am persuaded that the full life in the Spirit as promised by Christ and experienced by NT believers is still available for God's people today (John 10:10; 17:20; Acts 2:38–39; Eph 3:20–21; 4:11–13). It is the divine inheritance of all God's children to receive the fullness of Christ in the original power of the Holy Spirit.

(3) The church will fully experience the original kingdom power and life in the Holy Spirit only as it seeks with all its heart the righteousness and holiness set forth by God in the NT as his standard and will for all believers (2 Cor 6:14–18). Kingdom power and kingdom righteousness go together; they cannot be separated. Jesus states that we must seek both God's "kingdom and his righteousness" (Mat 6:33). The apostle Paul states that God's kingdom consists of both "power" (1 Cor 4:20) and "righteousness" (Rom 14:17). Thus the way to the fullness of God's kingdom with all its redemptive power is found in sincere faith in and devotion to the Lord Jesus Christ and in a separation from all unrighteousness that offends both God and the Holy Spirit whom he has poured out (Acts 2:17, 38–40).

In summary, the major purpose of this study Bible is to lead you, the reader, to an abiding faith in holy Scripture, and especially a deeper faith in the NT's apostolic message that will lead you to a greater expectancy for a NT experience made possible by the fullness of Christ living in the church (Eph 4:13) and by the fullness of the Holy Spirit living in the believer (Acts 2:4; 4:31).

We sincerely hope and pray that all readers will earnestly seek the NT church's devotion to God, its longing for the nearness of the risen Christ, its unshakable trust in and love for God's Word, its zeal for truth and righteousness, its mutual care for other believers, its compassion for the lost, its dedication to a life of fervent prayer, its passion for holiness, its fullness in the Spirit, its manifestation of spiritual gifts, its urgency to preach the gospel to all nations, and its hope for the imminent return of our Lord and Savior Jesus Christ.

I gratefully acknowledge that I owe a great debt to those who served on the Editorial Committee for this study Bible. Their evaluations and suggestions have been invaluable. They gave

of themselves and sacrificially took time from their own tasks to help in this work. What will be accomplished in God's kingdom through this work is in no small measure due to their help in the Lord. Also, I have benefited from the learning and labor of godly writers past and present who have produced a vast amount of literature and commentaries on the Holy Scriptures. I have thankfully entered into their research and expertise and have reaped where they have sown.

Throughout these years of labor I have felt a profound sense of weakness and unworthiness to expound on God's holy Word. Many times I have been driven to my knees in need of special grace and help. I can testify that God, who is rich in mercy and whose grace is sufficient, has sustained me by his Spirit. Through all the long days and hours his Word has spoken to my heart. My desire for a full manifestation of Biblical Christianity has deepened and developed into an intense longing that is surpassed only by my longing for that day of the appearing of our Lord and Savior. With thanks to God—the Father, the Son and the Holy Spirit—for the privilege of laboring in the Scriptures, I send forth this work unto him who loves us and gave himself for us so that we may have life and have it to the full (John 10:10).



Donald C. Stamps
November, 1991

Note: The author's and editor's royalties from the *KJV Life in the Spirit Study Bible* will go entirely to missions for the translating and printing of additional copies of the *KJV Life in the Spirit Study Bible* in foreign languages.

How to Use the KJV Life in the Spirit Study Bible

The *Life in the Spirit Study Bible* is designed to help you gain a more thorough understanding of the truths of God's Word, whereby you may grow in love, purity and faith toward the Lord Jesus Christ (1 Tim 1:5). The special features and study helps of the *Life in the Spirit Study Bible* are the following:

Sectional headings

The entire Bible contains sectional headings within the Bible text in order to help you more easily understand the subject and content of each section. NOTE: the standard King James Version sectional headings have been altered for this particular edition of the KJV. When two or more passages of Scripture are nearly identical or deal with the same event, this "parallel" is noted at the sectional headings for those passages. Identical or nearly identical passages are noted with "pp." Similar passages—those not dealing with the same event—are noted with "Ref."

Cross-reference system

The center-column cross-reference system is designed to help you connect one text of the Bible with others that have a similar theme. By using this system, difficult or obscure passages are clarified by Scripture itself. Cross references are indicated by raised light italic letters. A corresponding letter in the center column under the designated verse is followed by a list of appropriate Scripture verses.

When a single word is addressed by both text notes and cross references, the roman KJV text-note letter comes first. The cross references normally appear in the center column and, when necessary, continue at the bottom of the right-hand column preceding the KJV text notes.

The KJV cross-reference system resembles a series of interlocking chains with many links. The head, or organizing, link in each concept chain is indicated by the word "see". The appearance of a head link in a list of references usually signals another list of references that will cover a slightly different aspect of the concept or word being studied.

Study Notes

The study notes at the bottom of nearly every page are written from a Pentecostal perspective and with the belief that the full message, standard and experience testified to by Christ and the apostles are forever valid and available for his people today.

The study notes fall into five classes:

- (1) Expository. The notes explain the meaning of words and phrases of many important passages in the Word of God.
- (2) Theological. The notes define and explain the great doctrines and truths of the Bible, summarizing the Bible's teachings about baptism, forgiveness, perseverance, repentance, salvation, sanctification, etc.
- (3) Devotional. The notes emphasize the importance of maintaining an intimate and devoted relationship with God—the Father, the Son and the Holy Spirit—through faith, obedience, prayer and the many means of grace.
- (4) Ethical. The notes direct you to unreservedly commit yourself to God's kingdom and his righteousness. They emphasize the importance of Biblical principles of self-denial, godly conduct, following Christ, separation from sin, discernment of good and evil, and obligation to God and others.
- (5) Practical. The notes present useful information on the believer's daily walk. They contain practical instruction about healing, the baptism in the Spirit, bringing up godly children, spiritual warfare, overcoming worry, resisting temptations, etc.

The study notes provide extensive Scripture references (usually in parentheses) that confirm

comments made in the notes and help you in further in-depth Bible study. If the Scripture reference in parentheses is from the same chapter, it will normally appear first in the list, with the symbol “v.” or “vv.” Next will come Scripture references from the same book, usually without mention of the book’s name. Last in the parentheses are passages from other Bible books, given in Bible book order. In many cases, other notes and articles are also cross-referenced.

Articles

The articles deal with important subjects more comprehensively than do the notes. They usually appear in close proximity to one of the major texts related to the subject of the article. For a complete list of the articles, see the Table of Contents for Articles on p. viii.

The articles, like the study notes, provide extensive Biblical references in parentheses. In the articles, the name of each Bible book, in Bible book order, is usually given for each reference. If there is no book mentioned before a Scripture reference, it means that that reference is found in the same book as the previous reference.

Introductions

Each book of the Bible has an introduction, which includes (1) an outline of the book; (2) an explanation of the book’s background and historical setting, including information about the author, circumstances and date of writing; (3) a statement about the original purpose of the book; (4) a survey of its contents; (5) a list of the book’s special features and emphases; and (6) a suggested reading plan for covering the entire Bible in two years (one year for the OT and one year for the NT). Careful reading of the introductions will help you understand each book and its applications more fully. At the end of each introduction, space is provided for you to write personal notes on that book.

Themefinders™

On many pages of this Bible you will see one of 12 symbols in the margin, next to a vertical line. Each of these symbols represents a specific theme of importance in the Pentecostal tradition. They are:



Baptized in / Filled with the Holy Spirit
(Begin at Exodus 31:1–6)



Salvation
(Begin at Genesis 12:1–3)



Gifts of the Holy Spirit
(Begin at Exodus 35:30–35)



Second Coming
(Begin at Psalm 98:8–9)



Fruit of the Holy Spirit
(Begin at Genesis 50:19–21)



Victory over Satan and demons
(Begin at Genesis 3:15)



Healing
(Begin at Genesis 20:17–18)



Overcoming the world and worldliness
(Begin at Genesis 19:15–26)



Faith that moves mountains
(Begin at Genesis 15:3–6)



Praise
(Begin at Exodus 15:1–21)



Witnessing
(Begin at Exodus 10:1–2)



Walking in obedience and righteousness
(Begin at Genesis 5:22)

The symbol informs you which theme is contained in accompanying verses; at the bottom of each vertical line is a Bible text, directing you to the next text on that particular theme.

Charts

The *KJV Life in the Spirit Study Bible* contains various charts that will help you at a glance to learn more about the Bible and its teachings on such topics as the ministry of Jesus, the kingdom of God versus the kingdom of Satan, the last days of history, the gifts of the Holy Spirit, etc. See the Table of Contents for Maps and Charts on p. ix for a list of these charts.

Maps

A number of maps have been included within the Bible text to help you understand where the events written about in the Bible occurred. See the Table of Contents for Maps and Charts on p. ix for a list of these maps. At the back of this Bible are 16 full-color maps.

Subject Index

The subject index directs you to the most important notes and articles on the many topics and great doctrines of Scripture. Under each entry in this index, you will find texts of the Bible that have notes on that particular subject. Articles and introductions are also included in this index.

Themefinder™ Index

The Themefinder Index at the back of this Bible lists the Scripture passages assigned to the 12 key themes described earlier in the Themefinder section. Under each pertinent Themefinder you will find the passages in the order in which they are linked.

Reading Plan

The Reading Plan outlined in the back gives you the flexibility of choosing a method of reading through the Bible either in one year or in two years. The reading plan found at the end of each book introduction follows the two-year design, listing Old Testament readings for one year and New Testament readings for the second year.

Concordance

A concordance, compiled and edited by John R. Kohlenberger III and Edward W. Goodrick, is included to help you find Bible verses quickly and easily. By looking up key words in a Bible verse, you can find a verse for which you remember a word or two but not its location. For example, if you wanted to find out where the Bible says that the Word of God is “sharper than any double-edged sword,” you could look up either “sharper,” “double-edged” or “sword” in the concordance and find that the verse is located at Heb 4:12.

We trust that you will receive a rich blessing from using the *KJV Life in the Spirit Study Bible*. It is our prayer that your knowledge of God’s Word, your experience of the presence and power of the Holy Spirit, and your daily walk with Christ in truth and righteousness will increase through your use of this Bible.

The First Book of Moses, Called

Genesis

Outline

- I. The Beginnings of Human History (1:1—11:26)
 - A. Origin of the Universe and Life (1:1—2:25)
 - 1. Summary of All Creation (1:1—2:4)
 - 2. Expanded Creation Account of Adam and Eve (2:5—25)
 - B. Origin of Sin (3:1—24)
 - 1. Temptation and the Fall (3:1—6)
 - 2. Consequences of the Fall (3:7—24)
 - C. Origins of Civilization (4:1—5:32)
 - 1. Cain: Pagan Culture (4:1—24)
 - 2. Seth: A Righteous Remnant (4:25—26)
 - 3. Genealogical History of the Pre-flood Patriarchs (5:1—32)
 - D. The Great Flood: God's Judgment on Primeval Civilization (6:1—8:19)
 - 1. Universal Depravity (6:1—8,11—12)
 - 2. Noah: Preparation to Save a Righteous Remnant (6:9—22)
 - 3. Final Instructions and the Flood (7:1—8:19)
 - E. Humanity's New Beginning (8:20—11:26)
 - 1. The Posterity of Noah (8:20—10:32, Especially Shem, 10:21—31; 11:10—26)
 - 2. The Tower of Babel (11:1—9)
 - 3. Genealogical Links Between Shem and Abraham (11:10—26)
- II. The Beginnings of the Hebrew People (11:27—50:26)
 - A. Abraham (11:27—25:18)
 - 1. Abram's Family Background (11:27—32)
 - 2. Abram's Call and Journey of Faith (12:1—14:24)
 - 3. God's Formal Covenant With Abram (15:1—21)
 - 4. Hagar and Ishmael (16:1—16)
 - 5. Abrahamic Covenant Sealed by a New Name and Circumcision (17:1—27)
 - 6. Abraham's Promise and Lot's Tragedy (18:1—19:38)
 - 7. Abraham and Abimelech (20:1—18)
 - 8. Abraham and Isaac, the Son of Promise (21:1—24:67)
 - 9. The Posterity of Abraham (25:1—18)
 - B. Isaac (25:19—28:9)
 - 1. Birth of Esau and Jacob (25:19—26)
 - 2. Esau Sells His Birthright to Jacob (25:27—34)
 - 3. Isaac, Rebekah and Abimelech II (26:1—17)
 - 4. Dispute About Wells and the Move to Beer-sheba (26:18—33)
 - 5. The Patriarchal Blessing (26:34—28:9)
 - C. Jacob (28:10—37:2a)
 - 1. Jacob's Dream and Journey (28:10—22)
 - 2. Jacob With Laban in Haran (29:1—31:55)
 - 3. Jacob and Esau Reconciled (32:1—33:17)
 - 4. Jacob's Return to the Promised Land (33:18—35:20)
 - 5. The Posterity of Jacob and Esau (35:21—37:2a)
 - D. Joseph (37:2b—50:26)
 - 1. Joseph and His Brothers in Canaan (37:2b—36)
 - 2. Judah and Tamar (38:1—30)

3. Joseph's Testing and Promotion in Egypt (39:1—41:57)
4. Joseph and His Brothers in Egypt (42:1—45:28)
5. Joseph's Father and Brothers Settle in Egypt (46:1—47:26)
6. Jacob's Last Days, Final Prophecies and Death (47:27—50:14)
7. The Joseph Summary (50:15–26)

Author Moses

Theme Beginnings

Date of Writing c. 1445–1405 B.C.

Background

Genesis appropriately stands as the first book of the OT and serves as an essential introduction to the whole Bible. The book's title in Hebrew is derived from the first word of the book, *bereshith* ("in the beginning"). "Genesis," the title in our English Bible, is derived from the Greek translation of the Hebrew title and means "the origin, source or beginning of something." Genesis is "the book of beginnings."

The author of Genesis is nowhere designated in the book itself. The testimony of the rest of the Bible, however, is that Moses was the author of the entire Pentateuch (i.e., the first five OT books) and thus of Genesis (e.g., 1 Ki 2:3; 2 Ki 14:6; Ezra 6:18; Neh 13:1; Dan 9:11–13; Mal 4:4; Mark 12:26; Luke 16:29,31; John 7:19–23; Acts 26:22; 1 Cor 9:9; 2 Cor 3:15). Also, ancient Jewish writers and the early church fathers unanimously testify that Moses was the author/editor of Genesis. Insofar as the entire history of Genesis antedates Moses' life, his role in writing Genesis was largely to integrate, under the inspiration of the Holy Spirit, all the available written and oral records from Adam to the death of Joseph that are now preserved in Genesis. Perhaps an indication of the historical records used by Moses when writing Genesis is found in the 11 occurrences of the phrase, "these are the generations of" (Heb *'elleh toledoth*), which also may be translated as "these are the histories by" (see 2:4; 5:1; 6:9; 10:1; 11:10,27; 25:12,19; 36:1,9; 37:2).

Genesis accurately records creation, the beginnings of human history, and the origin of the Hebrew people and God's covenant with them through Abraham and the other patriarchs. Its historical reliability as inspired Scripture is certified in the NT by the Lord Jesus (Mat 19:4–6; 24:37–39; Luke 11:51; 17:26–32; John 7:21–23; 8:56–58) and by the apostles (Rom 4; 1 Cor 15:21–22,45–47; 2 Cor 11:3; Gal 3:8; 4:22–24,28; 1 Tim 2:13–14; Heb 11:4–22; 2 Pet 3:4–6; Jude 7,11). Its historicity continues to be confirmed by modern archaeological discoveries. Moses was remarkably prepared by education (Acts 7:22) and by God to write this unique first book of the Bible.

Purpose

Genesis provides an essential foundation for the remainder of the Pentateuch and all subsequent Biblical revelation. It preserves the only trustworthy record about the beginnings of the universe, humankind, marriage, sin, cities, languages, nations, Israel and redemptive history. It was written in accordance with God's purpose to give His covenant people in both the OT and NT a foundational understanding of Himself, creation, the human race, the fall, death, judgment, covenant and the promise of redemption through the offspring of Abraham.

Survey

Genesis divides naturally into two major parts. (A) Chs. 1–11 provide an overview of human beginnings from Adam to Abraham and focus on five epochal events. (1) Creation: God created all things, including Adam and Eve whom He placed in the Garden of Eden (chs. 1–2). (2) The Fall: Adam and Eve by their transgression introduced the curse of sin and death into human history (ch. 3). (3) Cain and Abel: This tragedy set in motion the two basic streams of history: humanistic civilization and a redemptive remnant (chs. 4–5). (4) The Great Flood: The ancient world had become so evil by the time of Noah's generation that God destroyed it by a universal flood, sparing only righteous Noah and his family as a remnant (chs. 6–10). (5) The tower of Babel: When the post-flood world unified in idolatry and rebellion, God dispersed it by fragmenting language and culture and by scattering the human race throughout the earth (ch. 11).

(B) Chs. 12–50 record the beginnings of the Hebrew people and focus on God's ongoing redemptive purpose through the lives of Israel's four great patriarchs—Abraham, Isaac, Jacob

and Joseph. God's call of Abraham/Abram (ch. 12) and His covenantal dealings with him and his descendants form the pivotal beginning of the outworking of God's purpose concerning a Redeemer and redemption in history. Genesis concludes with Joseph's death and the impending bondage of Israel in Egypt.

Special Features

Seven major features characterize Genesis. (1) It was the first book of the Bible written (with the possible exception of the book of Job), and it records the beginning of human history, sin, the Hebrew people and redemption. (2) The history in Genesis spans a larger period of time than the rest of the Bible combined, beginning with the first human couple, broadening to pre-flood world history, and then narrowing to Hebrew history as the redemptive stream that is traced throughout the remainder of the OT. (3) Genesis reveals that the material universe and life on earth are distinctly God's work and not an independent process of nature. Fifty times in chs. 1–2 God is the subject of verbs showing what He did as Creator. (4) Genesis is a book of firsts—recording the first marriage, first family, first birth, first sin, first murder, first polygamist, first musical instruments, first promise of redemption, and the like. (5) God's covenant with Abraham, which began with his call (12:1–3), was made formal in ch. 15 and was ratified in ch. 17, is central to all of Scripture. (6) Genesis alone explains the origin of the 12 tribes of Israel. (7) It reveals how Abraham's descendants ended up in Egypt (for 430 years) and thus sets the stage for the exodus, the central redemptive event in the OT.

New Testament Fulfillment

Genesis reveals the prophetic history of redemption and a Redeemer as coming through the offspring of the woman (3:15), through the line of Seth (4:25–26), through the line of Shem (9:26–27) and through the descendants of Abraham (12:2–3). The NT applies Gen 12:2–3 directly to God's provision of redemption in Jesus Christ (Gal 3:16,29). Numerous persons and events from Genesis are mentioned in the NT in relation to faith and righteousness (e.g., Rom 4; Heb 11:1–22), God's judgment (e.g., Luke 17:26–29,32; 2 Pet 3:6; Jude 7,11a) and the person of Christ (e.g., Mat 1:1; John 8:58; Heb 7).

Reading Genesis

In order to read the entire Old Testament in one year, the book of Genesis should be read in 21 days, according to the following schedule:

☐ 1–2	☐ 3–5	☐ 6–8	☐ 9–11	☐ 12–14
☐ 15–17	☐ 18–19	☐ 20–22	☐ 23–24	☐ 25–26
☐ 27–28	☐ 29–30	☐ 31–33	☐ 34–35	☐ 36–37
☐ 38–39	☐ 40–41	☐ 42–43	☐ 44–45	☐ 46–48
☐ 49–50				

Notes

The creation

1 In the ^abeginning ^bGod created the heaven and the earth.

2 And the earth was ^cwithout form, and void; and darkness *was* upon the face of the deep. ^dAnd the Spirit of God moved upon the face of the waters.

1:1
^aJohn 1:1,2
Heb. 1:10
^bPs. 8:3
Is. 44:24
Acts 17:24
Rev. 4:11
1:2
^cJer. 4:23
^dPs. 33:6
Is. 40:13,14
1:3
^ePs. 33:9
^f2 Cor. 4:6
1:5
^gPs. 74:16
1:6
^hJob 37:18
Jer. 10:12

"God," Heb *'elohim*. The *im* ending is the Hebrew plural. The singular form, *'eloah*, is found in Job. The Bible uses *'elohim* in the plural for the many pagan gods as well as for the one true God. For the true God the plural indicates that He sums up within Himself the completeness of all that is God, all that is divine.

3 ¶ And God said, ⁱLet there be light: and there was light.

4 And God saw the light, that *it was good*: and God divided ^athe light from the darkness.

5 And God called the light ^gDay, and the darkness he called Night. ^bAnd the evening and the morning were the first day.

6 ¶ And God said, ^hLet there be a ^cfirmament in the midst of the waters, and let it divide the waters from the waters.

1:7
ⁱProv. 8:28
^jPs. 148:4
1:9
^kJob 26:10
Prov. 8:29
Jer. 5:22
2 Pet. 3:5

7 And God made the firmament, ⁱand divided the waters which *were* under the firmament from the waters which *were* ^jabove the firmament: and it was so.

8 And God called the firmament Heaven. And the evening and the morning were the second day.

"Created," Heb *bara'*, used of God's bringing something new into existence. In addition to the original creation of Gen 1, it is used of bringing the nation of Israel into existence (Is 43:1), and even of initiating an act of judgment (Num 16:30, where "make a new thing" is literally "creates a creation"). Is 65:17 looks ahead to God's final act of creation, the new heavens and the new earth.

9 ¶ And God said, ^kLet the waters under the heaven be gathered together unto one place, and let the dry *land* appear: and it was so.

10 And God called the dry *land* Earth; and the gathering together of

^aHeb. *between the light and between the darkness* ^bHeb. *And the evening was, and the morning was, etc.* ^cHeb. *expansion*

1:1 In the beginning God created. "In the beginning" here is emphatic and draws attention to the fact of a real beginning. Other ancient religions, when speaking of creation, indicate that it came about out of something that was already there. They see history as occurring forever in cycles. The Bible looks at history in a linear way, with a God-given goal. God had a plan in creation, and He will carry it out. For comments on God and His role as Creator, see article on *Creation*, p. 6.

Several implications flow from the truth contained in the first verse of the Bible. (1) Since God is the source of all that exists, human beings and nature are not self-existent, but owe their being and continuance to him. (2) All existence and life is good if it is related rightly to God and dependent upon Him. (3) All life and creation can be eternally meaningful and purposeful. (4) God has sovereign rights over all creation by virtue of being its Creator. In a fallen world, He lays claim to those rights through redemption (Ex 6:6; 15:13; Deut 21:8; Luke 1:68; Rom 3:24; Gal 3:13; 1 Pet 1:18).

1:2 earth was without form, and void. This verse describes both the process God used in creating and the role of the Holy Spirit in creation (see article on *Creation*, p. 6).

1:3 Let there be light. The Hebrew word for "light" is *'or*, referring to the initial waves of light energy coming upon the earth. Later God placed "lights" (Heb *ma'or*, literally, light-bearers, v. 14)

in the heavens as permanent generators and reflectors of light waves. The primary purpose of these light-bearers was to serve for signs and seasons, and to mark days and years (vv. 5,14). For comments about the role of God's word or speech in creation, see article on *Creation*, p. 6.

1:5 And the evening and the morning were the first day. This designation is repeated six times in this chapter (vv. 5,8,13,19,23,31). The Hebrew word for day is *yom*. It normally means a 24-hour day (cf. 7:17; Mat 17:1), or the daylight portion of the 24 hours ("day" as distinct from "night"). But it also can refer to a time period of undetermined length (e.g., "time of harvest," Prov 25:13). Notice that 2:4 puts all six creation days together as "the day." Many believe the creation days were 24-hour days because they are described as consisting of an "evening" and "morning" (v. 5; cf. Ex 20:11). Others believe that "evening" and "morning" simply mean that a particular evening brought an end to that step of creation and the next morning brought a new beginning.

1:7 the firmament. The "firmament" refers to the atmosphere between the water on earth and the clouds above.

1:10 it was good. Seven times God states that what He created was "good" (vv. 4,10,12,18,21, 25,31). Each part of God's creation completely fulfilled his will and intended purpose. God created the world to reflect His glory and to be a place

the waters called he Seas: and God saw that *it was good*.

11 And God said, Let the earth bring forth ^dgrass, the herb yielding seed, *and* the fruit tree yielding ^mfruit after his kind, whose seed *is* in itself, upon the earth: and it was so.

12 And the earth brought forth grass, *and* herb yielding seed after his kind, and the tree yielding fruit, whose seed *was* in itself, after his kind: and God saw that *it was good*.

13 And the evening and the morning were the third day.

14 ¶ And God said, Let there be lights in the firmament of the heaven to divide ^ethe day from the night; and let them be for signs, and for seasons, and for days, and years:

15 And let them be for lights in the firmament of the heaven to give light upon the earth: and it was so.

16 And God made two great lights; the ^agreater light ^fto rule the day, and the ^olesser light to rule the night: *he made* ^pthe stars also.

17 And God set them in the firmament of the heaven to give light upon the earth,

18 And to ^qrule over the day and over the night, and to divide the light from the darkness: and God saw that *it was good*.

19 And the evening and the morning were the fourth day.

1:11
/Heb. 6:7
m Luke 6:44
1:16
n Ps. 136:8
o Ps. 8:3
p Job 38:7
1:18
q Jer. 31:35

1:21
r Ps. 104:26
1:22
s ch. 8:17
1:26
t Ps. 100:3
Eccl. 7:29
Eph. 4:24
Jas. 3:9
u ch. 9:2
Ps. 8:6

20 ¶ And God said, Let the waters bring forth abundantly the ^gmoving creature that hath life, and ⁱfowl that may fly above the earth in the ^jopen firmament of heaven.

21 And ^vGod created great whales, and every living creature that moveth, which the waters brought forth abundantly, after their kind, and every winged fowl after his kind: and God saw that *it was good*.

22 And God blessed them, saying, ^hBe fruitful, and multiply, and fill the waters in the seas, and let fowl multiply in the earth.

23 And the evening and the morning were the fifth day.

24 ¶ And God said, Let the earth bring forth the living creature after his kind, cattle, and creeping thing, and beast of the earth after his kind: and it was so.

25 And God made the beast of the earth after his kind, and cattle after their kind, and every thing that creepeth upon the earth after his kind: and God saw that *it was good*.

26 ¶ And God said, ^tLet us make man in our image, after our likeness: and ^ulet them have dominion over

^dHeb. tender grass ^eHeb. between the day and between the night ^fHeb. for the rule of the day, etc. ^gOr, creeping
^hHeb. soul ⁱ[Heb. let fowl fly] ^jHeb. face of the firmament of heaven

where humankind could share in His joy and life. Notice how God created according to a plan and order:

Day 1	light	bringing order to creation
Day 2	firmament	
Day 3	dry land	
Day 4	light-bearers	
Day 5	fish and birds	giving life to creation
Day 6	animals & humans	
Day 7	rest	creation is complete and good

1:14 be for signs. God intended that the sun, moon and stars serve as signs that point to Him as well as mark the advancing days, seasons and years. Astrology has twisted these intended purposes for the stars by proposing instead the false theory that the stars and planets guide the lives of people.

1:22 God blessed them. God blessed living creatures and declared nature and animals good (vv. 12,21–22). (1) God delighted in His work and valued it for itself. Likewise, believers should regard nature and its beauty and its animals as good, things to be enjoyed, and of immense value. (2) Although nature is now marred by sin, it still has great value as an expression of God's

glory and love for humankind (cf. Ps 19:1). Believers should pray for the complete liberation of creation from its bondage to sin and decay (Rom 8:21; Rev 21:1).

1:26 God said, Let us. This expression contains an early implication of the triune God. The use of the plural "us" suggests that God has a certain plurality (cf. Ps 2:7; Is 48:16). Revelation of the tri-unity of God does not become clear, however, until the NT (see Mat 3:17, note; Mark 1:11, note).

1:26 Let us make man. In vv. 26–28 we read about the creation of human beings; 2:4–25 gives more specific details about their creation and environment. These two accounts are complementary and teach several things. (1) Both man and woman were a special creation of God, not a product of evolution (v. 27; Mat 19:4; Mark 10:6).

(2) Man and woman were both created in the "image" and "likeness" of God. On the basis of this image, they could respond to and have fellowship with God and uniquely reflect His love, glory and holiness. They were to do so by knowing God and obeying him (2:15–17). (a) They possessed a *moral* likeness to God, for they were sinless and holy, possessing wisdom, a heart of love and the

bab: all these *were* the sons of Joktan.

30 And their dwelling was from Mesha, as thou goest unto Sephar, a mount of the east.

31 These *are* the sons of Shem, after their families, after their tongues, in their lands, after their nations.

32 *These are* the families of the sons of Noah, after their generations, in their nations: *and* by these were the nations divided in the earth after the flood.

The tower of Babel

11 And the whole earth was of one ¹language, and of one ^mspeech.

2 And it came to pass, as they journeyed ⁿfrom the east, that they found a plain in the land of Shinar; and they dwelt there.

3 And ^othey said one to another, Go to, let us make brick, and ^pburn *them* thoroughly. And they had brick

10:32
ⁱver. 1
^jch. 9:19

11:4
^kDeut. 1:28
11:5
^lch. 18:21

11:6
^mch. 9:19
Acts 17:26

ⁿver. 1
^oPs. 2:1

11:7
^pch. 1:26
^qch. 42:23

1 Cor. 14:2,11

for stone, and slime had they for mortar.

4 And they said, Go to, let us build us a city and a tower, ^kwhose top *may reach* unto heaven; and let us make us a name, lest we be scattered abroad upon the face of the whole earth.

5 ¹And the LORD came down to see the city and the tower, which the children of men builded.

6 And the LORD said, Behold, ^mthe people *is* one, and they have all ⁿone language; and this they begin to do: and now nothing will be restrained from them, which they have ^oimagined to do.

7 Go to, ^plet us go down, and there confound their language, that they may ^qnot understand one another's speech.

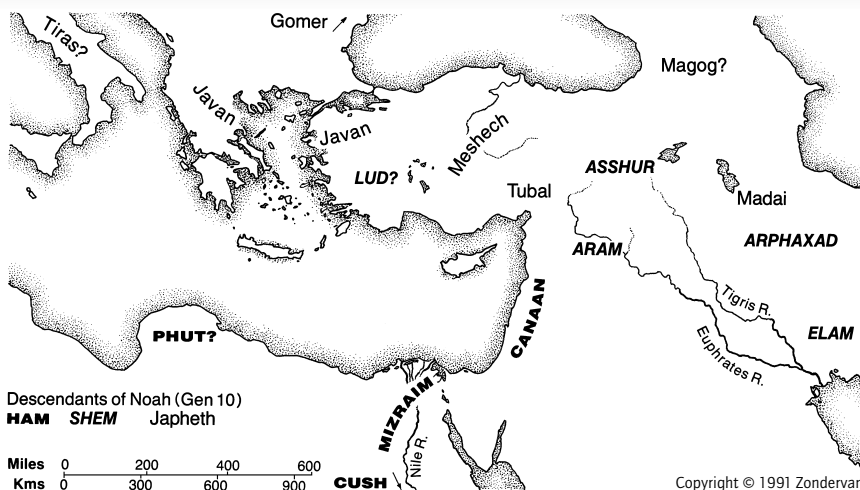
¹Heb. *lip* ^mHeb. *words* ⁿ[Or, *eastward*, as ch. 13:11; 2 Sam. 6:2; with 1 Chr. 13:6] ^oHeb. *a man said to his neighbour* ^pHeb. *burn them to a burning*

11:2 the land of Shinar. Shinar is the OT name for the territory of ancient Sumer and later of Babylonia or Mesopotamia.

11:4 let us build ... and let us make us a name. The sin of the people in the land of Shinar was the desire to dominate the world and their own destiny apart from God through man-centered organizational unity, power and great accomplishments. This purpose was based on pride and rebellion against God. God destroyed this effort by multiplying languages so that some

could no longer communicate with others (v. 7). From this event, the world may have derived both ethnic and language diversity. At this time the human race turned from God to idolatry, sorcery and astrology (cf. Is 47:12; see Ex 22:18, note; Deut 18:10, note on divination). The spiritual condition of humans is described in Rom 1:21–28. As a result, God gave them up to the impurity of their own hearts (Rom 1:24,26,28), and He turned to Abram to begin a way of salvation for humanity (see v. 31, note).

Table of Nations



The Spirit in the Old Testament

The Holy Spirit is one of the three persons of the eternal triune God (see Mark 1:11, note; see article on *The Doctrine of the Holy Spirit*, p. 1676). Although His full power was not revealed to God's people until the ministry of Jesus (see article on *Jesus and the Holy Spirit*, p. 1556) and, later, at Pentecost (see Acts 2), there are OT passages that refer to Him and His work. This article examines the OT teachings about the Holy Spirit.

Term Used. The Hebrew word for “Spirit” is *ruah*, a word that is sometimes translated as “wind” and “breath.” Thus, the OT references to the breath of life from God or a wind from God (e.g., Gen 2:7; Ezek 37:9–10,14) can also refer to the work of God's Spirit.

Joel 2:28–29

“And it shall come to pass afterward, that I will pour out my spirit upon all flesh; and your sons and your daughters shall prophesy, your old men shall dream dreams, your young men shall see visions: And also upon the servants and upon the handmaids in those days will I pour out my spirit.”

The Work of the Holy Spirit in the Old Testament.

The Bible describes various activities of the Holy Spirit during the OT times. (1) The Holy Spirit had an active role in creation. The Bible's second verse says that “the Spirit of God moved upon the face of the waters” (Gen 1:2), preparing for the creative word of God to shape the world. Both the Word of God (i.e., the second person of the Trinity) and the Spirit of God were agents in creation (see Job 26:13; Ps 33:6; see article on *Creation*, p. 6). The Spirit is also the author of life. When God created Adam, it was undoubtedly God's Spirit that breathed into him the breath of life (Gen 2:7; cf. Job 27:3), and the Holy Spirit continues to be involved in giving life to God's creatures (Job 33:4; Ps 104:30).

(2) The Spirit was active in communicating God's message to His people. For example, it was the Spirit who instructed the Israelites in the wilderness (Neh 9:20). When the psalmists of Israel sang their songs, they did so by the

Spirit of the Lord (2 Sam 23:2; cf. Acts 1:16,20). Similarly, the prophets were inspired by God's Spirit to declare His word to the people (Num 11:29; 1 Sam 10:5–6,10; 2 Chr 20:14; 24:19–20; Neh 9:30; Is 61:1–3; Mic 3:8; Zech 7:12; cf. 2 Pet 1:20–21). According to Ezekiel, one clue to detecting false prophets is that they “follow their own spirit” rather than the Spirit of God (Ezek 13:2–3); note, though, that it was possible for God's Spirit to come upon someone who was not in a right relationship with God in order to speak a true message regarding God's people (see Num 24:2, note).

(3) The leadership of God's OT people was energized by the Spirit of the Lord. Moses, for example, was one with the Spirit of God to such an extent that he shared God's very feelings, suffering when He suffered and becoming angry at sin when He became angry (see Ex 33:11, note; cf. Ex 32:19). When Moses obediently chose 70 elders to help him lead the Israelites, God took the Spirit that was on Moses and put it on them (Num 11:16–17; see 11:12, note). Similarly, when Joshua was commissioned to succeed Moses as leader, God indicated that “the spirit” (i.e., the Holy Spirit) was in him (Num 27:18, note). The same Spirit came upon Gideon (Judg 6:34), David (1 Sam 16:13) and Zerubbabel (Zech 4:6). In other words, in the OT the greatest qualification needed for leadership was the anointing and empowering presence of the Spirit of God.

(4) The Spirit of God could also come upon individuals to equip them for special service. A notable OT example was Joseph, who was given the Spirit to enable him to function effectively

in Pharaoh's cabinet (Gen 41:38). Also note Bezalel and Oholiab, whom God filled with His Spirit in order to do the artistic work needed for the tabernacle construction and also to teach others (see Ex 31:1–11; 35:30–35). The idea of “being filled with the spirit of God” here is not precisely the same as the baptism in the Holy Spirit in the NT (see article on *Baptism in the Holy Spirit*, p. 1662). In the OT, in other words, the Holy Spirit came upon and empowered only a few select individuals chosen for special service to God (see Ex 31:3, note). The Spirit of the Lord came upon many of the judges, such as Othniel (Judg 3:9–10), Gideon (Judg 6:34), Jephthah (Judg 11:29) and Samson (Judg 14:5–6; 15:14–16); these examples reveal God's enduring principle that when He chooses to use people greatly, the Spirit of the Lord comes upon them.

(5) There was also an awareness in the OT that the Spirit desired to lead a person on the level ground of righteous living; David testified to this in some of his psalms (Ps 51:10–13; 143:10). God's people who followed their own way instead of listening to God were really refusing to follow the way of the Spirit (see Gen 16:2, note). Those who failed to live by God's Spirit inevitably experienced some form of God's judgment (see Num 14:29, note; Deut 1:26, note).

(6) Note that in OT times the Holy Spirit came upon or filled only a few people, empowering them for service or prophecy. There was no general outpouring of the Holy Spirit on all Israel (cf. Joel 2:28–29; Acts 2:4, 16–18); the outpouring of the Spirit in this larger sense did not begin until the great day of Pentecost (Acts 2).

The Promise of the Full Power of the Spirit. The OT looks forward to the coming age of the Spirit, i.e., the NT age. (1) On several occasions, the prophets prophesied about the role that the Spirit would play in the life of the coming Messiah. Isaiah especially characterized the coming King and Servant of the Lord as one on whom the Spirit of God would rest in a special way (see Is 11:1–2; 42:1; 61:1–3). When Jesus read the words from Is 61 in His hometown synagogue at Nazareth, He ended with: “This day is this scripture fulfilled in your ears” (Luke 4:21).

(2) Other OT prophecies looked forward to the time when there would be a general outpouring of the Holy Spirit on all God's people. Most prominent among these passages is Joel 2:28–29, a text quoted on the day of Pentecost by Peter (Acts 2:17–18); but the same message can also be found in Is 32:15–17; 44:3–5; 59:20–21; Ezek 11:19–20; 36:26–27; 37:14; 39:29. God promised that when the life and power of His Spirit would come upon His people, they would be enabled to prophesy, see visions, have prophetic dreams, live lives of obedience, holiness and righteousness, and witness with great power. Thus the OT prophets foresaw and prophesied about the Messianic age when the outpouring of the Holy Spirit upon humanity would occur and be available for all people everywhere; this began to happen on Pentecost Sunday (ten days after Jesus ascended into heaven), with a subsequent great harvest of salvation (cf. Joel 2:28, 32; Acts 2:41; 4:4; 13:44, 48–49).

The Gospel According to S. Matthew

Outline

- I. Introduction to the Messiah (1:1—4:11)
 - A. The Jewish Lineage of Jesus (1:1—1:17)
 - B. His Birth and Flight to Egypt (1:18—2:23)
 - C. Prophetic Forerunner to the Messiah (3:1—1:12)
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- III. The Climax of Jesus' Messianic Mission in Judea/Perea and Jerusalem (19:1—26:46)
 - A. Jesus' Journey to Jerusalem (19:1—20:34)
 - B. Jesus' Last Week at Jerusalem (21:1—26:46)
 1. The Triumphal Entry and the Cleansing of the Temple (21:1—2:2)
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- IV. Jesus' Arrest, Trial and Crucifixion (26:47—27:66)
 - A. The Arrest (26:47—5:6)
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- V. The Resurrection (28:1—2:0)
 - A. The Women's Glorious Discovery (28:1—1:0)
 - B. False Witnesses (28:11—1:5)
 - C. The Risen Lord's Commission (28:16—2:0)

Author Matthew

Theme Jesus, the Messianic King

Date of Writing A.D. 60s

Background

This Gospel is appropriately placed first as an introduction to the NT and to "the Christ, the Son of the living God" (16:16). Although the author is not identified by name in the Biblical text, the unanimous testimony of all early church fathers (beginning c. A.D. 130) is that this Gospel was written by Matthew, one of Jesus' 12 disciples.

Whereas Mark's Gospel was written for the Romans (see the Introduction to Mark) and Luke's Gospel for Theophilus and for all Gentile believers (see the Introduction to Luke), Matthew's Gospel was written for Jewish believers. The Jewish background of this Gospel is evident in many ways, including: (1) it relies on OT revelation, promises and prophecy to prove that Jesus was the long-awaited Messiah; (2) it traces Jesus' lineage, starting from Abraham (1:1–17); (3) it repeatedly declares that Jesus is the "Son of David" (1:1; 9:27; 12:23; 15:22; 20:30–31; 21:9, 15; 22:41–45); (4) it uses preferred Jewish terminology such as "kingdom of heaven" (a synonym for "kingdom of God") because of the Jews' reverential reluctance to say the name of God directly; and (5) it refers to Jewish customs without any explanation (unlike the other Gospels).

However, this Gospel is not exclusively Jewish. Like the message of Jesus Himself, Matthew's Gospel was intended ultimately for the whole church, faithfully revealing the universal scope of the gospel (e.g., 2:1–12; 8:11–12; 13:38; 21:43; 28:18–20).

The date and location of this Gospel's origin are uncertain. However, there are good reasons for believing that Matthew wrote prior to A.D. 70 while in The Holy Land or Syrian Antioch. Some Bible scholars believe Matthew was the first of the four Gospels to be written; others ascribe that place to the Gospel of Mark.

Purpose

Matthew wrote this Gospel (1) to provide his readers with an eyewitness account of Jesus' life, (2) to assure his readers that Jesus was God's Son and the long-awaited Messiah foretold by the OT prophets, and (3) to show that God's kingdom was manifested in and through Jesus in an unprecedented way. Matthew is concerned that his readers understand (1) that Israel for the most part rejected Jesus and His kingdom, refusing to believe because He came as a spiritual rather than as a political Messiah, and (2) that only at the end of the age will Jesus come in glory as the King of kings to judge and rule the nations.

Survey

Matthew presents Jesus as the fulfillment of Israel's prophetic hope. Jesus fulfills OT prophecy in His birth (1:22–23), birthplace (2:5–6), return from Egypt (2:15) and residence in Nazareth (2:23); as the one for whom the Messianic forerunner was sent (3:1–3); in the primary location of His public ministry (4:14–16), His healing ministry (8:17), His role as God's servant (12:17–21), His teaching in parables (13:34–35), His triumphal entry into Jerusalem (21:4–5) and His arrest (26:50).

Chs. 5–25 record five major discourses by Jesus and five major narratives about His mighty deeds as Messiah. **The five major discourses are:** (1) the Sermon on the Mount (chs. 5–7); (2) instruction for itinerant proclaimers of the kingdom (ch. 10); (3) parables about the kingdom (ch. 13); (4) the character of true disciples (ch. 18); and (5) the Olivet discourse about the end of the age (chs. 24–25). **The five major narratives in this Gospel are:** (1) Jesus performs mighty deeds and miracles, which testify about the reality of the kingdom (chs. 8–9); (2) Jesus further demonstrates the presence of the kingdom (chs. 11–12); (3) Jesus' proclamation of the kingdom provokes various crises (chs. 14–17); (4) Jesus journeys to Jerusalem and spends His last week there (19:1–26:46); (5) Jesus is arrested, tried, crucified and raised from the dead (26:47–28:20). The last three verses of the Gospel record Jesus' "Great Commission."

Special Features

Seven major features characterize this Gospel. (1) It is the most Jewish of the NT Gospels. (2) It contains the most systematic arrangement of Jesus' teaching and ministry of healing and deliverance. This led the church in the second century to rely heavily on it for instructing new converts. (3) The five major discourses contain the most extensive blocks of material in the Gospels on Jesus' teaching (a) during His Galilean ministry, and (b) on the subject of eschatology (the last things). (4) This Gospel specifically identifies events in Jesus' life as fulfilling the OT more than any other NT book. (5) It mentions the kingdom of heaven/kingdom of God more than any other Gospel. (6) Matthew emphasizes (a) the righteous standards of the kingdom (chs. 5–7); (b) the present power of the kingdom over sin, sickness, demons and even death; and (c) the future triumph of the kingdom in that final victory at the end of the age. (7) It is the only Gospel to mention or predict the church as a future entity belonging to Jesus (16:18; 18:17).

The genealogy of Jesus

1:1–17pp — Luke 3:23–38

1:3–6pp — Ruth 4:18–22

1:7–11pp — 1 Chr 3:10–17

1 The book of the ^ageneration of Jesus Christ, ^bthe son of David, ^cthe son of Abraham.

² ^aAbraham begat Isaac; and ^eIsaac begat Jacob; and ^fJacob begat Judas and his brethren;

³ And ^gJudas begat Phares and Zara of Thamar; and ^hPhares begat Esrom; and Esrom begat Aram;

⁴ And Aram begat Aminadab; and Aminadab begat Naasson; and Naasson begat Salmon;

⁵ And Salmon begat Booz of Rachab; and Booz begat Obed of Ruth; and Obed begat Jesse;

⁶ And ⁱJesse begat David the king; and ^jDavid the king begat Solomon of *her that had been the wife of* Urias;

⁷ And ^kSolomon begat Roboam; and Roboam begat Abia; and Abia begat Asa;

⁸ And Asa begat Josaphat; and Josaphat begat Joram; and Joram begat Ozias;

⁹ And Ozias begat Joatham; and Joatham begat Achaz; and Achaz begat Ezekias;

¹⁰ And ^lEzekias begat Manasses; and Manasses begat Amon; and Amon begat Josias;

¹¹ And ^mJosias begat Jechonias and his brethren, about the time they were ⁿcarried away to Babylon:

¹² And after they were brought to Babylon, ^oJechonias begat Salathiel; and Salathiel begat ^pZorobabel;

1:1

^a Luke 3:23^b Ps. 132:11

Is. 11:1

Jer. 23:5

ch. 22:42

John 7:42

Acts 2:30

Rom. 1:3

^c Gen. 12:3

1:2

^d Gen. 21:2^e Gen. 25:26^f Gen. 29:35

1:3

^g Gen. 38:27^h Ruth 4:18

1 Chr. 2:5

1:6

ⁱ 1 Sam. 16:1

& 17:12

^j 2 Sam. 12:24

1:7

^k 1 Chr. 3:10

1:10

^l 2 Ki. 20:21

1 Chr. 3:13

1:11

^m See 1 Chr.

3:15,16

ⁿ 2 Ki. 24:14-16

& 25:11

^o 2 Chr. 36:10

Jer. 27:20

& 52:11,15

Dan. 1:2

1:12

^p 1 Chr. 3:17^q Ezra 3:2

Neh. 12:1

Hag. 1:1

¹³ And Zorobabel begat Abiud; and Abiud begat Eliakim; and Eliakim begat Azor;

¹⁴ And Azor begat Sadoc; and Sadoc begat Achim; and Achim begat Eliud;

¹⁵ And Eliud begat Eleazar; and Eleazar begat Matthan; and Matthan begat Jacob;

¹⁶ And Jacob begat Joseph the husband of Mary, of whom was born Jesus, who is called Christ.

¹⁷ So all the generations from Abraham to David *are* fourteen generations; and from David until the carrying away into Babylon *are* fourteen generations; and from the carrying away into Babylon unto Christ *are* fourteen generations.

The birth of Jesus

¹⁸ ¶ Now the ^qbirth of Jesus Christ was on this wise: When as his mother Mary was espoused to Joseph, before they came together, she was found with child ^rof the Holy Ghost.

¹⁹ Then Joseph her husband, being a just *man*, and not willing ^sto make her a publick example, was minded to put her away privily.

²⁰ But while he thought on these *things*, behold, *the* angel of the Lord appeared unto him in a dream, saying, Joseph, *thou* son of David, fear not to take unto *thee* Mary thy wife: ^tfor that which is ^bconceived in her is of the Holy Ghost.

^a Some read, *Josias begat Jakim, and Jakim begat Jechonias* ^b [Gr. *begotten*]

1:1 generation of Jesus Christ. Matthew's Gospel opens with this genealogy that traces Jesus' ancestral lineage through the paternal line (the line of Joseph), as was Jewish custom (v. 16). Although Joseph was not Jesus' biological father (v. 20), he was His legal father. Since God had promised that the Messiah would be a descendant of Abraham (Gen 12:3; 22:18; Gal 3:16) and David (2 Sam 7:12–19; Jer 23:5), Matthew traces Jesus' legal lineage back to these two men in order to demonstrate to the Jews that Jesus had the proper genealogy to qualify as the Messiah. **1:1 Christ.** The word "Christ" (Gk *christos*) means "anointed"; it is the Greek equivalent of the Hebrew term "Messiah" (Dan 9:25–26). (1) From the beginning Matthew affirms that Jesus is God's Anointed One, anointed with the Holy Spirit (cf. Is 61:1; Luke 4:18; John 3:34; Acts 10:38). (2) Jesus was anointed as Prophet to bring knowledge and truth (Deut 18:15); as Priest to offer the sacrifice and cancel the guilt (Ps 110:4; Heb

10:10–14); and as King to establish, rule, and lead the kingdom of righteousness (Zech 9:9).

1:1 son of David. (1) Matthew establishes that Jesus was a legal descendant of David by tracing the genealogy of Joseph, who was of the house of David. Although Jesus was conceived by the Holy Spirit, He was still formally registered as Joseph's son and legally a son of David. (2) Luke's genealogy (Luke 3:2338) traces the lineage of Jesus through the males in Mary's line (she was also from the Davidic line). Luke stresses that Jesus is the flesh and blood (i.e., offspring) of Mary and therefore one of us (cf. Rom 1:3). Thus, the Gospel writers assert both Jesus' legal and biological right to the Messiahship.

1:16 Mary . . . Jesus. The virgin birth of Jesus is safeguarded in the genealogy. Notice the word "begat" is used of all the names down to Joseph, but then the statement is altered. It is not said that Joseph "begat" Jesus, but rather that Joseph



21 "And she shall bring forth a son, and thou shalt call his name JESUS: for ^vhe shall save his people from their sins.

1:21
^uLuke 1:31
^vActs 4:12
 & 5:31
 & 13:23,38
 1:23
^wIs. 7:14

Mat 1:21

"JESUS," Jesus (*Isous*) is the Greek equivalent of the Hebrew word *Yeshua* (Joshua), meaning "Yahweh saves" or "Yahweh is salvation." This describes the future task of Mary's Son and is the initial promise of the gospel. Jesus as Savior "shall save his people from their sins." Sin is the greatest enemy of the human race, destroying one's soul and life. Through the atoning death of Jesus Christ and the sanctifying power of the Holy Spirit, those who turn to Him will be set free from the guilt and slavery of sin (see John 8:31–36; Acts 26:18; Rom 6; 8:1–16).

22 Now all this was done, that it might be fulfilled which was spoken of the Lord by the prophet, saying,

23 "Behold, a virgin shall be with child, and shall bring forth a son, and ^dthey shall call his name Emmanuel, which being interpreted is, God with us.

24 Then Joseph being raised from sleep did as the angel of the Lord had bidden him, and took unto *him* his wife:

25 And knew her not till she had

1:25
^xEx. 13:2
 Luke 2:7,21
 2:1
^yLuke 2:4,6
^zGen. 25:6
 1 Ki. 4:30
 2:2
^aLuke 2:11
^bNum. 24:17
 Is. 60:3

brought forth ^xher firstborn son: and *he* called his name JESUS.

The coming of the wise men

2 Now when ^yJesus was born in Bethlehem of Judea in the days of Herod the king, behold, there came wise men ^zfrom the east to Jerusalem,

2 Saying, ^aWhere is he that is born King of the Jews? for we have seen ^bhis star in the east, and are come to worship him.

3 When Herod the king had heard

"A virgin," The Hebrew word for "virgin" (*almah*) used in Is 7:14 and the equivalent Greek word *parthenos*, used in the Septuagint in Is 7:14 and in Mat 1:23 and Luke 1:27 for Mary, means a young virgin (normally a "maiden" of marriageable age). In addition to the meaning of the Greek and Hebrew (which some dispute), Matthew and Luke emphasize that Jesus was conceived of the Holy Ghost (1:18,20; Luke 1:35,37) without the intervention of a human father (Luke 1:34) and given birth by Mary while still a virgin (1:25; see 1:16, note; 1:23, note). Joseph and Mary did not have sexual union until after Mary gave birth to Jesus (1:25).

^c[That is, *Saviour*, Heb.]

^dOr, *his name*

shall be called

Mat 1:23

was the "husband of Mary, of whom was born Jesus" (see v. 23, note).

1:21 JESUS. *Jesus* is the Greek form of the Hebrew word *yeshua* (Joshua), meaning "The LORD is salvation" (see Josh. 1:1, note).

1:23 virgin . . . bring forth a son. The prophecy of Isaiah in the OT (7:14; cf. Mat 1:22–23) and both Matthew and Luke in the NT ascribe virginity to the mother of Jesus. The Biblical revelation of Jesus' virgin conception and birth is commonly opposed by liberal scholars and some cults. But the revelation in Mat 1 and Luke 1 is clear and unequivocal (see Word Study above on Mat 1:23).

(1) The importance of the virgin birth cannot be overemphasized. In order for our Redeemer to qualify to pay for our sins and bring salvation, He must be, in one person, fully human, sinless and fully divine (Heb 7:25–26). The virgin birth satisfies all three of these requirements. (a) The only way Jesus could be born a human being was to be born of a woman. (b) The only way He could be sinless was to be conceived by the Holy Spirit (1:20; cf. Heb 4:15). (c) The only way He could be divine was to have God as His Father. As a result, His conception was not by natural but by supernatural means: "that holy thing which shall be born of thee shall be called the Son of God" (Luke 1:35). Jesus Christ is therefore revealed to us as

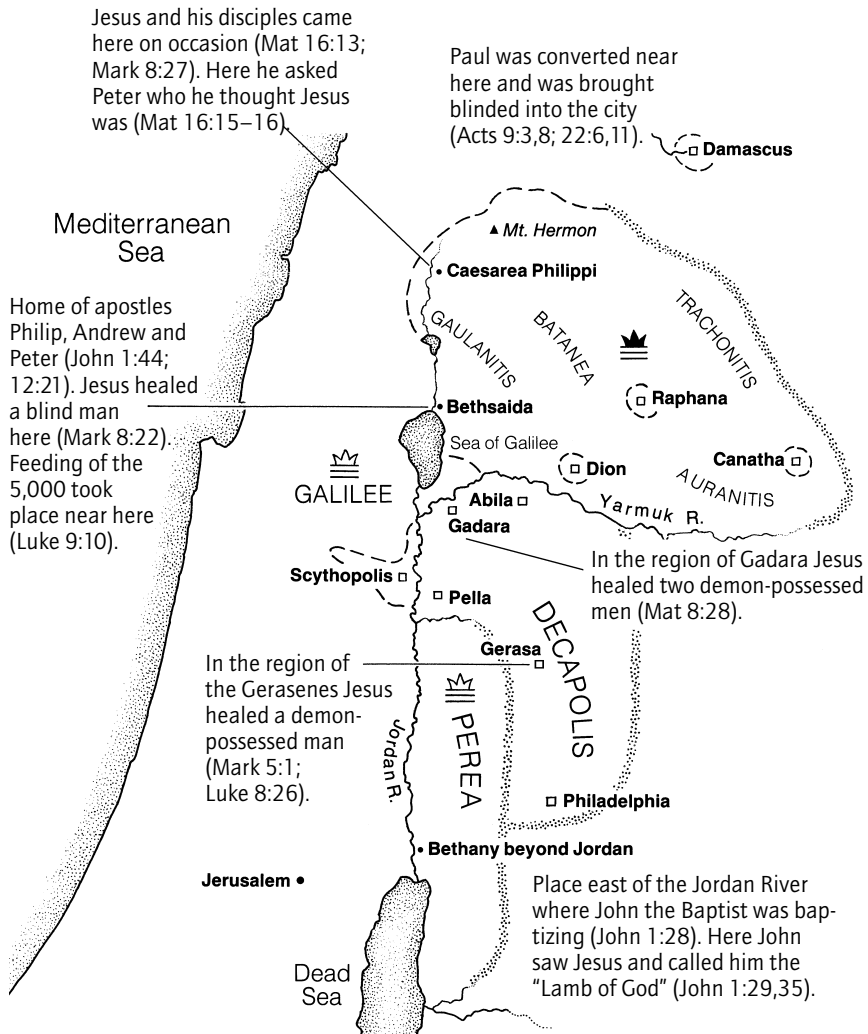
one divine person with two natures—divine and sinless human.

(2) In living and suffering as a human person, Jesus sympathizes with our weaknesses (Heb 4:15–16). As the divine Son of God, He has the power to deliver us from sin's bondage and Satan's power (Acts 26:18; Col 2:15; Heb 2:14; 7:25). As both divine and sinless human, He qualifies to serve as a sacrifice for the sins of every person and as a high priest to intercede for all who come to God (Heb 2:9–18; 5:1–9; 7:24–28; 10:4–12).

1:25 knew her not till. The word "till" draws attention to the fact that after Christ's birth, Joseph and Mary entered into the full physical union commonly associated with marriage. We are told that Jesus had brothers and sisters (12:46–47; Mark 3:31–32; 6:3; Luke 8:19–20).

2:1 wise men. These men were probably members of a learned religious class from the region now called Iran. They specialized in astrology, medicine and natural science. Their visit occurred when Jesus was between 40 days (cf. Luke 2:22) and 2 years old (cf. v. 16). The importance of this story is that (1) Jesus is worthy of royal honor from all humanity, and (2) Gentiles as well as Jews are included in God's redemptive plan (cf. 8:11; 28:19; Rom 10:12).

Decapolis and Lands beyond the Jordan



Miles 10 5 0 10 20
Kms 10 5 0 10 20 30

8 ^aBlessed *are* the pure in heart: for ^athey shall see God.

9 Blessed *are* the peacemakers: for they shall be called the children of God.

10 ^aBlessed *are* they which are persecuted for righteousness' sake: for theirs is the kingdom of heaven.

11 ^aBlessed are ye, when *men* shall revile you, and persecute *you*, and shall say all manner of ^aevil against you ⁱfalsely, for my sake.

12 ^aRejoice, and be exceeding glad: for great *is* your reward in heaven: for ^aso persecuted they the prophets which were before you.

Teaching about salt and light

13 ¶ Ye are the salt of the earth: ^abut if the salt have lost his savour, wherewith shall it be salted? it is thenceforth good for nothing, but to

5:8
q Ps. 15:2
Heb. 12:14
r 1 Cor. 13:12
5:10
s 2 Cor. 4:17
1 Pet. 3:14
5:11
t Luke 6:22
u 1 Pet. 4:14
5:12
v Luke 6:23
Acts 5:41
1 Pet. 4:13
w Neh. 9:26
Acts 7:52
5:13
x Mark 9:50
Luke 14:34

5:14
y Prov. 4:18
Phil. 2:15
5:15
z Mark 4:21
Luke 8:16
5:16
a 1 Pet. 2:12
b John 15:8

be cast out, and to be trodden under foot of men.

14 ^aYe are the light of the world. A city that is set on a hill cannot be hid.

15 Neither do men ^alight a candle, and put it under ^aa bushel, but on a candlestick; and it giveth light unto all that are in the house.

16 Let your light so shine before men, ^athat they may see your good works, and ^bglorify your Father which is in heaven.

The higher righteousness

17 ¶ ^aThink not that I am come to

ⁱGr. *lying* ⁱThe word in the original signifieth a measure containing about a pint less than a peck

1 Cor. 14:25 5:17 c Rom. 10:4

either from sin or sorrow. The merciful sincerely want to make such suffering less by bringing those people to the grace and help of God through Jesus Christ (cf. 18:23–35; Luke 10:30–37; Heb 2:17). In showing mercy to others, we “shall obtain mercy.”

5:8 the pure in heart. The “pure in heart” are those who have been delivered from sin’s power by God’s grace and now strive without deceit to please and glorify God and to be like Him. (1) They seek to have the same attitude of heart that God has—a love of righteousness and a hatred of evil (see Heb 1:9, note). Their hearts (which includes their minds, wills and emotions; see article on *The Heart*, p. 936) are in tune with the heart of God (1 Sam 13:14; Mat 22:37; 1 Tim 1:5). (2) Only the pure in heart “shall see God.” To see God means to be His child and to dwell in His presence, both now and in the future kingdom (Ex 33:11; Rev 21:7; 22:4).

5:9 the peacemakers. The “peacemakers” have been reconciled to God. They have peace with Him through the cross (Rom 5:1; Eph 2:14–16; see article on *The Peace of God*, p. 1134). They now strive by their witness and by their lives to bring others, including their enemies, to peace with God.

5:10 persecuted for righteousness' sake. Persecution will be the lot of all who seek to live in harmony with the Word of God for the sake of righteousness. (1) Those who uphold God’s standards of truth, justice and purity and who at the same time refuse to compromise with the present evil society or the lifestyles of lukewarm believers (Rev 2; 3:1–4, 14–22) will undergo unpopularity, rejection and criticism. Persecution and opposition will come from the world (10:22; 24:9; John 15:19) and at times from those within the professing church (Acts 20:28–31; 2 Cor 11:3–15; 2 Tim 1:15; 3:8–14; 4:16). When they experience this suffering, Christians are to rejoice (v. 12), for

to those who suffer most God imparts the highest blessing (2 Cor 1:5; 2 Tim 2:12; 1 Pet 1:7; 4:13). (2) Christians must beware of the temptation to compromise God’s will in order to avoid shame, embarrassment or loss (10:33; Mark 8:38; Luke 9:26; 2 Tim 2:12). The principles of God’s kingdom never change: “all that will live godly in Christ Jesus shall suffer persecution” (2 Tim 3:12). Those who suffer and endure persecution because of righteousness are promised the kingdom and heavenly rewards.

5:13 salt of the earth. As salt is valuable to give flavor and to preserve from corruption. Hence, believers and the church must be godly examples in the world and must resist the moral decay and corruption evident in society. (1) Churches that become lukewarm, quench the power of the Holy Spirit and cease to resist the prevailing spirit in the world will be “cast out” by God (see Rev 3:15–16, note). (2) They consequently will be “trodden under foot of men”; i.e., those who are lukewarm will be destroyed by the ways and values of an ungodly society (cf. Deut 28:13, 43, 48; Judg 2:20–22).

5:17 the law . . . to fulfil. The expression “the law and the prophets” sometimes is used comprehensively for the entire OT. It was not Christ’s intention to abolish OT revelation but rather to see it fulfilled in the lives of His followers (Rom 3:31; 8:4). The NT believer’s relation to the law of God involves the following:

(1) The “law” that the believer is obliged to keep consists of the ethical and moral principles of the OT (7:12; 22:36–40; Rom 3:31; Gal 5:14; see article on *The Old Testament Law*, p. 126) as well as the teachings of Christ and the apostles (Mat 28:20; 1 Cor 7:19; 9:21; Gal 6:2). These laws reveal God’s moral nature and His will for the lives of His people and, therefore, still apply today. OT laws that applied directly to the nation of Israel, such as the sacrificial, ceremonial, social or

Divine Healing

God's Redemptive Provision. (1) The problem of sickness and disease is intertwined with the problem of sin and death—i.e., the consequences of the fall. Whereas medical science views the causes of sickness and disease in physiological or psychosomatic terms, the Bible presents spiritual causes as the underlying or basic problem: (a) *sin*, which has affected our spiritual and physical makeup (e.g., John 5:5,14), and (b) *Satan* (e.g., Acts 10:38; cf. Mark 9:17,20,25; Luke 13:11; Acts 19:11–12).

(2) God's provision in redemption is as extensive as the consequences of the fall. For sin, God provides forgiveness; for death, God provides eternal and resurrection life; and for sickness, God provides healing (cf. Ps 103:1–5; Luke 4:18; 5:17–26; Jas 5:14–15). Thus, during Jesus' earthly life, His threefold ministry was *teaching* God's word, *preaching* repentance (the sin problem) and the blessings of God's kingdom (life), and *healing* every kind of sickness, disease and infirmity among the people (Mat 4:23–24).

Mat 8:16–17

"When the even was come, they brought unto him many that were possessed with devils: and he cast out the spirits with his word, and healed all that were sick: That it might be fulfilled which was spoken by Esaias the prophet, saying Himself took our infirmities, and bare our sicknesses."

Revelation Concerning God's Will. God's will concerning healing is revealed in four main ways in Scripture.

(1) *God's own pronouncement.* In Ex 15:26 God promised health and healing for His people if they remained faithful to His covenant and commands (see Ex 15:26, note). His pronouncement was twofold: (a) "I will put none of these diseases upon thee [as judgment], which I have brought upon the Egyptians" and (b) "I am the LORD that healeth thee [as Redeemer]." God continued to be the doctor or healer of His OT people whenever they earnestly sought His face and obeyed His word (cf. 2 Ki 20:5; Ps 103:3).

(2) *Jesus' ministry.* Jesus as the incarnate Son of God was and is the exact representation of God's nature and character (Heb 1:3; cf. Col 1:15; 2:9). In His earthly ministry (Mat 4:23–24; 8:14–16; 9:35; 15:28; Mark 1:32–34,40–41; Luke 4:40; Acts 10:38), Jesus revealed God's will in action (John 6:38; 14:10), and thus shows conclusively that it is in God's heart, nature and purpose to heal all who are sick and oppressed by the devil. Although Jesus did not heal every sick person in the Holy Land, the gospels often record that He healed individuals, groups of people, and "all" who were sick and brought to Him (Mat 4:24; Mark 6:56; Luke 6:19; 9:11). Healing was a normal part of Jesus' proclamation of the kingdom of God.

(3) *The provision of Christ's atonement* (Is 53:4–5; Mat 8:16–17; 1 Pet 2:24). Jesus' atoning death was complete and adequate for redeeming the whole person—spirit, soul and body. As sin and sickness have become the twin giants designed by Satan to destroy us, so forgiveness and healing are twin blessings designed by God to redeem us and make us whole (cf. Ps 103:3; Jas 5:14–16). The believer should press on in humility and faith to possess the full provision of Christ's atonement, including the healing of the body.

(4) *The ongoing ministry of the church.* Jesus commissioned His 12 disciples to heal the sick as part of their proclamation of God's kingdom (Luke 9:1–2,6). Later, He commissioned 70 disciples to do the same (Luke 10:1,8–9,19). After Pentecost, the early church carried on Jesus' healing ministry as part of preaching the gospel (Acts 3:1–10; 4:30; 5:16; 8:7; 9:34; 14:8–10;

19:11–12; cf. Mark 16:18; 1 Cor 12:9,28,30; Jas 5:14–16). The NT records three ways that God's healing power and faith were imparted through the church: (a) the laying on of hands (Mark 16:15–18; Acts 9:17), (b) confession of known sin, followed by anointing the sick with oil and the prayer of faith (Jas 5:14–16), and (c) spiritual gifts of healings given to the church (1 Cor 12:9). Note that it is the elders who are to pray the prayer of faith.

Hindrances to Healing. Sometimes there are hindrances to receiving divine healing, such as, (1) unconfessed sin (Jas 5:16), (2) demonic oppression or bondage (Luke 13:11–13), (3) fear or acute anxiety (Prov 3:5–8; Phil 4:6–7), (4) past disappointments that undermine present faith (Mark 5:26; John 5:5–7), (5) people (Mark 10:48), (6) unbiblical teaching (Mark 3:1–5; 7:13), (7) failure of the elders to pray the prayer of faith (Mark 11:22–24; Jas 5:14–16), (8) failure of the church to seek and obtain the gifts of miracles and healings as God intended (Acts 4:29–30; 6:8; 8:5–6; 1 Cor 12:9–10,29–31; Heb 2:4), (9) unbelief (Mark 6:3–6; 9:19,23–24), and (10) self-centered behavior (1 Cor 11:29–30). At other times, the reason for the persistence of physical affliction in godly people is not readily apparent (e.g., Gal 4:13; 1 Tim 5:23; 2 Tim 4:20). In still other instances, God chooses to take His beloved saints to heaven during an illness (cf. 2 Ki 13:14).

Steps to Take. What can you do when praying for and seeking God's healing of your body? (1) Be sure you are in a right relationship with God and others (Mat 6:33; 1 Cor 11:27–30; Jas 5:16; see John 15:7, note).

(2) Seek the presence of Jesus in your life, for it is He who will give your heart the faith you need (Rom 12:3; 1 Cor 12:9; Phil 2:13; see Mat 17:20, note on true faith).

(3) Saturate your life with God's Word (John 15:7; Rom 10:17). God sends forth His Word to heal (Ps 107:20). He also watches over the promises of His Word to fulfill them (Jer 1:12; Is 53:11). Let God's promises about healing enter into your spirit as revelation. Active faith can then unite with God's Word (Heb 4:2) for a creative miracle.

(4) Call for the prayers of the elders of the church with the anointing of oil, as well as the prayers of family members and friends (Jas 5:14–16).

(5) Attend a service where a person with a respected healing ministry is present (cf. Acts 5:15–16; 8:5–7).

(6) Expect a miracle—trust in Christ's power (Mat 7:8; 19:26).

(7) Rejoice if healing comes this day. Rejoice even if it does not come in the present hour (Phil 4:4,11–13).

(8) If you are not finding healing, continue to remain in Him (John 15:1–7). Examine your life to see what changes God may desire to work in you.

(9) Know that God's delays in answering prayers are not necessarily denials of those requests. Sometimes God has a larger purpose in mind that, when realized, results in His greater glory (cf. John 9:3; 11:4,14–15,45; 2 Cor 12:7–10) and is good for us (Rom 8:28).

(10) Realize that if you are a committed Christian, God will never forsake you or forget you. He loves you so much that He has engraved you on the palms of His hands (Is 49:15–16).

Note: The Bible acknowledges the proper use of medical care (Mat 9:12; Luke 10:34; Col 4:14).

The Kingdom of God Versus the Kingdom of Satan

A. THE NATURE OF THE KINGDOMS

ITEM	Kingdom of God		Kingdom of Satan	
	DESCRIPTION	REFERENCE	DESCRIPTION	REFERENCE
1. Rulership	a. Rule by God—Theocracy	2Ch 20:6; Ps 95:3; Da 4:17,32; 1Ti 1:17	a. Rule by Satan—the god of this age	Jn 12:31; 14:30; 2Co 4:4; Eph 2:2; 1Jn 5:19
	b. God's rule through his Son	Ps 110:1; Isa 9:6–7; Da 7:13–14; Mt 28:18; Lk 1:32–33; Eph 1:20–22; Heb 1:3–8; Rev 1:5; 19:13–16	b. Satan assisted by principalities, powers and rulers of this dark world	Eph 1:21; 6:12; Col 1:16; 2:15; cf. Da 10:13
2. Character	a. Righteousness, peace and joy in the Holy Spirit	Mt 6:33; Jn 18:36; Ro 14:17	a. Centered in the things of this world	1Jn 2:15–17; 5:19; Rev 2:9,13
	b. Divine power	Lk 11:20–22; 1Co 2:4; 4:20; 1Th 1:5	b. Disease, sickness, slavery	Mt 10:1; Lk 9:1
	c. Truth	Jn 8:31–32; 14:6,16–17; 15:26; 16:13; 17:17	c. Deception	Ge 3:4–5,13; Jn 8:44; Ro 1:25; 2Co 4:4; 2Th 2:10–12
	d. Holiness	1Co 1:2,30; 2Co 6:17–7:1; Eph 4:24; Heb 12:10,14; 1Pe 1:15–16	d. Sin and evil	Ro 1:28–32; 1Co 6:9–10; Eph 2:1–3; 1Jn 3:7–10,12
	e. Light	Jn 1:4–9; 3:19; Ac 26:18; Col 1:12–13; 1Ti 6:16; 1Jn 1:5,7	e. Darkness	Lk 22:53; Ac 26:18; Eph 6:12; Col 1:13; 1Jn 1:6; cf. 2Co 11:14
3. Manifestation	a. Salvation	Mk 1:15; Ac 8:12; 1Co 5:10–11	a. Destruction	Jn 10:10; 1Pe 5:8
	b. Baptism in the Holy Spirit	Mt 3:2,11–12; Ac 1:3–8	b. Filled with the spirit of the world	1Co 2:12; Jas 4:4; 1Jn 2:15
	c. Miracles and driving out demons	Mt 4:23–24; 10:7–8; 12:28; Lk 9:1–2,11; 11:20–22; 13:11–16	c. By counterfeit miracles and demon-possession	Mt 4:24; 8:28; 24:24; 2Th 2:9; Rev 13:13–14
	d. The presence of Jesus	Mt 3:1–3; 4:17; Mk 1:14–15	d. The presence of evil spirits	Mt 8:28; 12:22–29; Mk 5:2–5,9; 6:7; Ac 19:16; Rev 18:2

The Kingdom of God Versus the Kingdom of Satan

ITEM	Kingdom of God		Kingdom of Satan	
	DESCRIPTION	REFERENCE	DESCRIPTION	REFERENCE
3. Manifestation (cont.)	e. Gifts of the Spirit	Ro 12:6–8; 1Co 12:1–31	e. Sorcery, witchcraft, drugs, occult activity	Ac 16:16; 19:18–19; 1Co 10:20; Gal 5:20; Rev 2:24
	f. Fruit of the Spirit	Gal 5:22–23	f. Acts of the sinful nature	Gal 5:19–21

B. THE PEOPLE OF THE KINGDOMS

1. Entrance	a. Repentance and forgiveness	Mk 1:15; Ac 2:37–38; 1Jn 1:9	a. All unregenerate humanity	Ro 3:23; Eph 2:2–3; Col 1:13
	b. Humility	Mt 18:3; Mk 10:15	b. Pride, independence	Ps 2:1–2; Pr 16:18; Eze 16:40–50; Da 4:30; Ob 3; Ro 1:30; 2Ti 3:2; Jude 16
	c. Confession and faith	Ro 10:8–13; Heb 4:2	c. Rebellion and unbelief	Ro 1:18–32; Heb 3:19; 12:25
	d. New birth	Jn 3:3,5	d. Spiritual death	Ro 5:12,17; 6:23; Eph 2:1; Col 2:13
	e. Union with Christ	Ro 6:3–8	e. Separation from God	Eph 2:12
2. Characteristics of Members	a. Children of God	Jn 1:12–13; 3:3–5; Ro 8:15; Gal 4:5; Eph 1:5	a. Children of Satan	Jn 8:44; 1Jn 3:8–10
	b. Faith and obedience	Mt 6:25–32; Jn 14:21; Ro 1:5; 16:26; Heb 11:6	b. Unbelief and rebellion	Mt 17:17; Lk 12:46; 2Th 3:2; Tit 1:15; Rev 21:8
	c. Eternal life	Jn 3:16,36; 5:24; 6:40; 1Jn 2:25; 5:11; Rev 2:7	c. Eternal death	Jn 3:18,36; Ro 5:12; 6:23; Jas 1:15; 1Jn 5:12; Rev 20:14–15; 21:8
	d. Walk in the light	Ro 13:13; Eph 5:8; Php 2:15; 1Th 5:5,8	d. Walk in darkness	Jn 3:19; Ro 13:12–13; Eph 5:11–12; 1Jn 1:6; 2:9,11
	e. Devoted to the truth	2Th 2:13; 1Ti 3:15; 3Jn 3–5	e. Speak lies and oppose truth	Jn 8:44; Ro 1:18,25; 2Ti 2:18; 3:8; 4:4

Subject Index

This subject index will enable you to locate where various topics are discussed in the study notes, introductions and articles.

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ABIDE IN CHRIST

John 15:4,6; 1 John 3:6

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Mark 13:14

ABRAHAM

See article on THE CALL OF ABRAHAM

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Ex 20:14; Prov 6:32-33
spiritual
Jer 3:1-5; Ezek 16:15; 23:2; Rev 17:1
suspected
Num 5:18

woman caught in
John 8:7,11

ADVICE

godly
1 Sam 25:32; 2 Ki 25:7; Prov 15:22

AMEN

2 Cor 1:20

AMOS

See introduction to Amos
Amos 1:1

ANGEL OF THE LORD

See article on ANGELS AND THE ANGEL OF THE LORD
Gen 16:7; 32:24; Ex 3:2; Judg 6:14; Is 63:9; Zech 1:8-11,12

ANGELS

See article on ANGELS AND THE ANGEL OF THE LORD

fallen

See article on POWER OVER SATAN AND DEMONS
2 Pet 2:4

good

Gen 18:2; 32:1; Ezek 1:5; 9:2; Dan 10:5; Heb 1:13; Rev 8:13

guardian

Gen 24:40; Gen 28:12; 2 Ki 6:16-17; Ps 34:7; 91:11; Mat 18:10

ANGER

at sin

Ex 32:19; Judg 10:7; Neh 13:25; Luke 19:45; Acts 17:16

God's

1 Ki 18:40; Ps 76:10; Lam 1:12; Amos 8:11; Nah 1:3; Rom 1:18,24

ANNA

Luke 2:36

ANOINTING

counterfeit
Mat 7:23
of Cyrus
Is 45:1

from the Holy Spirit

1 Sa 10:1; Is 11:2-3; 42:1; 1 John 2:20

of priests

Num 3:3

ANTICHRIST

See article on THE AGE OF THE ANTICHRIST

as the beast of the great tribulation
Is 14:12-15; Dan 6:5; 7:8,24-25; 9:27; 11:36-45; Zech 11:15-16; Rev 11:7; 13:1-3,8,15,18; 16:10; 17:16

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as the "man of sin"

2 Thes 2:3; 1 John 2:18

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2 Thes 2:6

ANTINOMIANISM

Gen 3:4; Rom 16:17; 1 John 2:4

ANXIETY

Mat 6:25; Phil 4:6,7

APOSTASY

Gen 19:26; Judg 17:5,6; 20:1; 2 Ki 12:2; 2 Chr 16:7; Eccl 11:9; Is 2:6-9; 30:1-5; Jer 8:12

of believers

See article on CHRIST'S MESSAGE TO THE SEVEN CHURCHES

See article on INDIVIDUAL APOSTASY

Deut 29:18-21; 2 Ki 14:26; 15:16; Prov 14:14; Lam 2:5; Luke 8:13; John 15:2,6; 1 Cor 6:9; 9:27; Gal 5:4; Heb 2:1; 10:29; 2 Pet 2:1; Jude 12; Rev 3:5; 22:19

and repentance

1 Ki 8:46

and the last days

See article on THE AGE OF THE ANTICHRIST

Mat 24:11,12; Luke 18:8; 2 Thes 2:7; 1 Tim 4:1; 2 Tim 4:3

Themefinder™ Index

This Themefinder™ Index will provide an “at-a-glance” listing of the passages assigned to a particular theme of importance in the Pentecostal tradition. Themefinders link the most significant texts on crucial Bible topics.

Baptized in/Filled with the Holy Spirit



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Numbers 27:18
Judges 3:9–10
Judges 6:34
Judges 11:29
Judges 15:14–15
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Ezekiel 36:26–27
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1 Thessalonians 1:6
Hebrews 12:11
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The Entire Bible in a Year

God's Word is His personal message of love to you today. A great way to grow as a Christian and get to know God in a more personal way is to spend time in His Word. Here are three ways for you to read through the Bible:

1. If you are reading the Bible for the first time: Begin by reading the Gospel of Mark or the Gospel of John in the New Testament. After reading one of these gospels, read the book of Acts or the book of Romans. After reading Acts or Romans, pick an Old Testament book like Genesis or perhaps Psalms.

2. If you want to read through the entire Bible in one year: Read three chapters each day, Monday through Saturday, and five chapters on Sunday.

3. If you want to read through the entire Bible in two years: Read two chapters each day, Sunday through Saturday.

The following chart covers every book and chapter of the Bible. To keep track of what you have read, mark off each chapter as you complete it.

GENESIS

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 11 12 13 14 15 16 17 18 19 20 21 22 23 24 25 26 27 28 29 30
31 32 33 34 35 36 37 38 39 40 41 42 43 44 45 46 47 48 49 50

EXODUS

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 11 12 13 14 15 16 17 18 19 20 21 22 23 24 25 26 27 28 29 30
31 32 33 34 35 36 37 38 39 40

LEVITICUS

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 11 12 13 14 15 16 17 18 19 20 21 22 23 24 25 26 27

NUMBERS

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 11 12 13 14 15 16 17 18 19 20 21 22 23 24 25 26 27 28 29 30
31 32 33 34 35 36

DEUTERONOMY

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 11 12 13 14 15 16 17 18 19 20 21 22 23 24 25 26 27 28 29 30
31 32 33 34

JOSHUA

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 11 12 13 14 15 16 17 18 19 20 21 22 23 24

JUDGES

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 11 12 13 14 15 16 17 18 19 20 21

RUTH

1 2 3 4

Concordance

TO THE OLD AND NEW TESTAMENTS

For each verse quoted in this concordance, an italicized single letter followed by a period is used to designate the word entry. The texts chosen for each word are in Bible book order under the entry. Occasionally the verses under a word entry contain different forms of that entry (for example, under the word **ABASE**, entries may contain "abased" or "abasing"). Those alternate forms of the word have been placed in parentheses after the key word. The context of each verse will help the reader understand which form of the word fits the italicized letter.

A

ABASE (ABASED, ABASING)

Job 40:11 every one that is proud, and *a*.
Is. 31: 4 nor *a*. himself for the noise of them
Ezek. 21:26 *a*. him that is high
Dan. 4:37 shall be *a*. from thy estimation
Mat. 23:12 exalt himself shall be *a*.
2 Cor. 11: 7 offence in *a*. myself

ABATED

Gen. 8: 3 fifty days the waters were *a*.
Dan. 27:18 shall be *a*. from thy estimation
Deut. 34: 7 nor his natural force *a*.
Judg. 8: 3 their anger was *a*. towards

ABHOR (ABHORRED, ABHORREST, ABHORRETH, ABHORRING)

Ex. 5:21 made our savour to be *a*.
Lev. 26:11 my soul shall not *a*. you
26:15 if your soul *a*. my judgments
26:30 my soul shall *a*. you
26:43 their soul *a*. my statutes
26:44 neither will I *a*. them
Deut. 23: 7 shall not *a*. an Edomite
32:19 when the Lord saw it he *a*. them
1 Sam. 2:17 for men *a*. the offering
27:12 made his people to *a*. him
Job 19:19 my inward friends *a*. me
30:10 they *a*. me, they flee
33:20 so that his life *a*. bread
42: 6 I *a*. myself, and repent
Ps. 5: 6 Lord will *a*. the bloody
10: 3 covetous, whom the Lord *a*.
22:24 nor *a*. the affliction of the afflicted
36: 4 he *a*. not evil
89:38 cast off and *a*. . . . thine anointed
106: 40 he *a*. his own inheritance
107: 18 their soul *a*. all manner of meat
119:163 I hate and *a*. lying
Prov. 22:14 *a*. of the Lord shall fall
Is. 49: 7 him whom the nation *a*.
66:24 be an *a*. unto all flesh
Jer. 14:21 do not *a*. us for thy name's sake
Lam. 2: 7 Lord hath *a*. his sanctuary
Amos 5:10 they *a*. him that speaketh
6: 8 I *a*. the excellency of Jacob
Mic. 3: 9 house of Israel that *a*. judgment
Zech. 11: 8 their soul also *a*. me
Rom. 2:22 thou that *a*. idols

ABIDE

Ex. 16:29 *a*. ye every man in his place
Num. 35:25 *a*. in it unto the death of the high
2 Sam. 11:11 Israel, and Judah, *a*. in tents
Ps. 15: 1 who shall *a*. in thy tabernacle
61: 4 I will *a*. in thy sanctuary
61: 7 he shall *a*. before God for ever
91: 1 *a*. under the shadow of the Almighty
Prov. 7:11 her feet *a*. not in her house
19:23 that hath it shall *a*. satisfied

Hos. 3: 3 shall *a*. for me many days
3: 4 Israel shall *a*. without a king
Joel 2:11 terrible; who can *a*. it
Mal. 3: 2 who may *a*. the day of his
Mat. 10:11 there *a*. till ye go thence
Luke 19: 5 I must *a*. at thy house
24:29 *a*. with us; for it is toward
John 14:16 Comforter, that he may *a*. with you
15: 4 *a*. in me and I in you
15:10 ye shall *a*. in my love, *a*. in his
Acts 20:23 bonds and afflictions *a*. me
1 Cor. 3:14 if any man's work *a*.
7: 8 good for them if they *a*. even as I
7:20 every man *a*. in the same
7:24 is called therein *a*. with God
Phil. 1:24 to *a*. in the flesh is needful
1:25 know that I shall *a*. with you
1 John 2:24 let that therefore *a*. in you
2:27 ye shall *a*. in him
2:28 little children *a*. in him

ABIDETH (ABIDING)

Ps. 49:12 man being in honour *a*. not
55:19 even he that *a*. of old
Eccl. 1: 4 the earth *a*. for ever
John 3:36 wrath of God *a*. on him
5:38 not his word *a*. in you
8:35 but the Son *a*. for ever
12:24 except it die it *a*. alone
12:34 Christ *a*. for ever
15: 5 he that *a*. in me bringeth forth
2 Tim. 2:13 yet he *a*. faithful
1 Pet. 1:23 word of God *a*. for ever
1 John 3: 6 whoso *a*. in him sinneth not
3:15 no murderer hath eternal life *a*.
3:24 hereby we know he *a*. in us

ABILITY

Mat. 25:15 every man according to his several *a*.
1 Pet. 4:11 as of the *a*. God giveth

ABLE

Ex. 18:21 *a*. men, such as fear God,
Lev. 14:22 such as he is *a*. to get
Deut. 16:17 every man give as he is *a*.
2 Chr. 20: 6 none is *a*. to withstand
Dan. 3:17 God is *a*. to deliver
4:37 walk in pride he is *a*. to abase
Mat. 9: 3 God is *a*. of these stones to raise
9:28 believe ye I am *a*. to do this?
10:28 are not *a*. to kill the soul
19:12 he that is *a*. to receive it, let
4:33 as they were *a*. to hear
Mark 10:29 no man is *a*. to pluck them
John 4:21 he was *a*. to perform
Rom. 14: 4 God is *a*. to make him stand
1 Cor. 3: 2 neither yet now are ye *a*.
10:13 tempted above that ye are *a*.
2 Cor. 9: 8 *a*. to make all grace abound
Phil. 3:21 *a*. to subdue all to himself
2 Tim. 1:12 *a*. to keep that which
3:15 which are *a*. to make thee wise
Heb. 2:18 *a*. to succour the tempted

5: 7 *a*. to save him from death
7:25 *a*. to save to the uttermost
11:19 *a*. to raise him from dead
Jas. 1:21 *a*. to save your souls
4:12 *a*. to save and to destroy
Jude 1:24 *a*. to keep you from falling

ABODE

John 14:23 make our *a*. with him

ABOLISH (ABOLISHED)

Is. 2:18 idols he shall utterly *a*.
51: 6 righteousness shall not be *a*.
Ezek. 6: 6 your works may be *a*.
2 Cor. 3:13 to the end of that which is *a*.
Eph. 2:15 having *a*. in his flesh
2 Tim. 1:10 Jesus Christ hath *a*. death

ABOMINABLE

Lev. 7:21 or any *a*. unclean thing
18:30 commit not any one of these *a*. customs
1 Chr. 21: 6 king's word was *a*. to Joab
Job 15:16 how much more *a*. is man
Ps. 14: 1 have done *a*. works
Is. 14:19 thy grave like an *a*. branch
Jer. 16:18 carcasses of thy detestable and *a*. things
44: 4 do not this *a*. thing that I hate
Nah. 3: 6 I will cast *a*. filth on thee
Tit. 1:16 in works deny him being *a*.
1 Pet. 4: 3 walked in *a*. idolatries
Rev. 21: 8 unbelieving and *a*. shall

ABOMINATION (ABOMINATIONS)

2 Ki. 21: 2 the *a*. of the heathen
Ezra 9:14 join people of these *a*.
Prov. 6:16 seven things are an *a*. to Lord
11: 1 a false balance is *a*. to the Lord
11:20 they of a froward heart are *a*.
12:22 lying lips are *a*. to the Lord
15: 8 sacrifice of wicked is an *a*.
15:26 thoughts of wicked are an *a*.
16: 5 proud in heart is an *a*. to Lord
20:23 divers weights are an *a*. to the Lord
26:25 seven *a*. in his heart
28: 9 even his prayer shall be *a*.
Is. 1:13 incense is an *a*. unto me
Jer. 7:10 delivered to do all these *a*.
Ezek. 16: 2 cause Jerusalem to know her *a*.
18:13 hath done all these *a*. shall die
Dan. 9:27 for the overspreading of *a*.
11:31 place the *a*. that maketh desolate
12:11 *a*. that maketh desolate set up
Mat. 24:15 see the *a*. of desolation
Luke 16:15 is *a*. in the sight of God
Rev. 17: 5 mother of harlots and *a*.

ABOUND (ABOUNDED, ABOUNDING)

Prov. 28:20 faithful shall *a*. with blessings
Mat. 24:12 because iniquity shall *a*.
Rom. 3: 7 truth of God hath more *a*.
5:20 that the offence might *a*.
6: 1 in sin that grace may *a*.

Index to Color Maps

The Index to Color Maps will lead you to place-names found on the color maps in the back of this Bible. References are to the map number and map margin markings.

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Abel Meholah **7 C3**
Abel Shittim **3 D2**
Abila **9 C1/C2**
Abilene **9 D1; 11 H4; 13 H4**
Acco **2 D1; 4 B2; 5 A3; 6 B2; 9 B2; 11 B2**
Achaia **13 D3; 14 C3**
Adora **9 B5**
Adriatic Sea **13 C2; 14 C2**
Aegean Sea **1 A1; 13 E2; 14 D3**
Africa **13 B3; 14 B3**
Ai **1 C3; 3 C2**
Aijalon **6 B4**
Aleppo **1 C2; 5 B1; 8a B1; 8b B4; 12 C1; 13 H3**
Alexandria **14 D3**
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Alps **14 B2**
Altar **10 C3**
Amathus **9 C3**
Amman **2 E2; 9 C4**
Ammon **3 D2; 4 D3; 5 B3; 6 C3; 7 D4**
Amphipolis **13 E2**
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Ararat **8a B1; 8b B4**
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Beautiful, Gate **10 C3**
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